

Chemical Engineering Meeting

December 8th, 2017

Attendees

1. Vikas Berry
2. Sanjay Behura
3. Shafiqh Mehraeen
4. Sultana Ferdous
5. Meenesh Singh
6. Sangil Kim
7. Ludwig Nitsche
8. Alan Zdunek
9. Gang Cheng
10. Lew Wedgewood
11. Vivek Sharma
12. Michael Caracotsios

Minutes from 9/1/17: Add Sultana to the Lab Safety Committee, Minutes Passed

Chemical Engineering

- 279 BS Students
- 100 Graduate Students
 - 52 PhD
 - 36 MS
 - 13 China Program
- 16.25 Faculty (5.25 Tenure, 5 Tenure Track, 4 Clinical, 2 Research)
- **Congratulations** to Brian Chaplin on attaining Tenure
- Research Expenditures Q1 = \$286,000 (+98%)
 - Hoping to pass \$1 million this year
- International Programs: 3+2 China Program & GAP (in the final stages of program organization)
- \$2.5 million operating budget

Research Proposals

- Number of proposals = 20
- Proposed = \$5.8 million
- Awarded in FY 18 = \$493,000
- Keep writing and focusing on big proposals to submit
- Number of Expenditures \$800,000-\$1 million

Congratulations to Meenesh Singh on his PNS NSF paper

Undergraduate Admissions

- Fall 17: 76 new students (+31% from 58 the previous year)
- Spring 2018
 - Admitted = 20
- Fall 2018
 - Admits have doubled 67 from 31, 2 ITEs already
- Need contact information for spring transfer admits
- Graduating Spring 2017: 13 students

\$2.5 Million Operating Budget FY18 (+31%)

New Building

- The Dean is still holding the space in the South Western corner, MIE on second floor in the South Eastern corner
- No more wind chamber
- Student lounge is in the North Eastern corner

Past Events

- Open House 9/16/17 went very well, thank you to all that helped
- Research Symposium 10/13/17 got good feedback on the event
 - Introduce seminars/mentoring/workshops on how to be a good presenter throughout the year
 - Berry & Singh have a focus group with mentoring for students looking to go into faculty positions

Annual Luncheon is on Thursday 12/21/17 at bellyQ at 11:30 a.m.

Satish Saxena Professorship

- Full Professor position: Research
- Department already has areas of strength, need to find someone to support and strengthen so the department can submit proposals for larger awards
- Need to create a committee to identify the type of professor the department needs
- Computational candidate
- Membrane separation and materials are the department strengths but need computational support
- Dr. Singh suggested DFD computational
- Identify department strengths and find gaps so the search committee can find an appropriate candidate

Karen will be leaving the department to join Dr. Nitsche at the college. She will leave on 3/1/18, but will be available to help train the new person. Search for the replacement has started

Walter Scindler

- has been absent for weeks and the college is looking to eliminate his position
- Jan will fill in where possible and is not looking to leave the department anytime soon and has already learned a great deal from Walter.
- However, Walter leaving will be a great knowledge loss. He knows all the inventory, machines, and labs best.
- Perhaps bringing him back for the move would be a great help. Jan has machine shop training.
- Should still consider hiring another person to assist Jan.

Building Move

- Timing of the move needs to be perfect (preferably over the summer) to disassemble, reassemble, and check that they are functioning properly before start of the semester
- About \$ 1 million available for the move
- Will have a new boiler in the building

Building Safety

- Thefts in the building
- Bathroom disasters because of non-university people
- Need a sign for people to know it is not a public building
- Starting 12/18/17 the building will be i-card access only, but creates an issue for delivery
- Install cameras in labs?

Undergraduate Committee

- 132 Total applications: 61 female, 71 male
- 74 Admitted
- The requirements have been lowered and hoping the quality and level of student is not going down
- College of DuPage recruitment day went very well
- 20 Companies were at Industry day on November 17th
- Tuesday 12/12/17 graduation luncheon for 13 graduating undergraduate students
- Students are doing poorly, more than half failed Wedgewood's midterm exam
- Need to meet to see trends and issues to discover if the problem is the students or the professors
- Dr. Ferdous has noted that half the transfer students have the necessary knowledge in the courses while the other half do not. She recommends mandatory mentorship
- Ascertain that the full curriculum is being covered to be prepared for the next level course. If not, it could cause issues when getting ABET approval
- Need to be more communication between professors

ChemE Car Competition 12/21/17 9:30-10:30 a.m. This will be the first car produced by CHE. The competition will be judged by Vikas, Alan, Shafigh, and Betul in room 230.

TA Issue

- TA position issue regarding positions in Biological Sciences
- TA positions are offered to PhD and Masters students
- The college has been pushing for no TA positions being offered MS students because the tuition waivers come from the budget
- Biological Sciences revoked TA offers after COE told them their policy and then informed the students
- The colleges came into an agreement for the semester to pay COE \$3,000 for every student they hire. Now green lighted to rehire the students
- Only a temporary fix
- The request from the college is not an order and not enforceable
- RA recruitment from other departments of one of our students, department still pays the tuition waiver but the hiring department pays their stipend

Graduate

- Decrease in both MS and PhD

AY 17	AY 18
14 MS	4 MS
9 PhD	4 PHD

- 4 admitted, 1 MS and 1 PhD deferred into Spring 2018
- Political impact on application
- Should contact applicants that haven't completed their application to encourage them to complete it
- Encourage recruitment of Masters students
- DGS wants to still recruit certain students despite low GPA
- Dr. Caracotsios: Purdue gets companies to sponsor research projects and puts 3 students to a project
 - Dr. Caracotsios mentors some groups at Purdue
 - Any findings remain the intellectual property of the sponsor
 - Sponsors pay tuition → MIE is doing this during the summer and started evening courses
 - Companies want to partner with departments to create training programs
- Provide certificate training during the summer or evenings (or early morning)
- Focus on student success and advertise it
- Create Alumni List
- Tweet out newsletter of students every 6 months or after every semester
- Alumni survey form should be easier to get to
- Collect salary information on undergraduates or use national survey of salaries
- Most students are accepting over \$55,000

China Visit

- ECAS has no chemical engineering program
- Nanjing 20 students are interested
 - Dean and the Assistant Dean want to visit next summer

Department Seminars Spring 2018

- February 13 Bryan Boudaris, Purdue University Host: Vivek Sharma
<https://engineering.purdue.edu/Powerlab/Pages/MainPages/Home.html>
- February 15 Rigoberto Hernandez, Johns Hopkins Host: Shafigh Mehraeen
<https://rh.jhu.edu/web/>
- February 19, Tzahi Cohen-Carni, CMU Host: Vikas Berry <http://www.cohenkarni.com>
- March 6, Jiwoong Park, University of Chicago Host: Vikas Berry <http://park-lab.uchicago.edu>
- March 15, Yushan Yan, Delaware Host: Meenesh Singh <http://yan.cbe.udel.edu>
- April 5, Chinedum Oseji, Yale (moving to UPenn) Host: Vivek Sharma
<https://www.eng.yale.edu/polymers/index.shtml>
- Satish Saxena Distinguished Lecturer 2018: Dr. Paula Hammond, Head of the Department of Chemical Engineering at MIT

COE Executive Board

Dr. Brian Chaplin attained Tenure.

No WISEST update

- Grad committee may change course structure and add new courses
- Policy on TA support for students struggling in current semester who are slated for next semester
- A “C” grade is not good standing
- Students need to maintain good standing for their 1st semester to get a TA again for their 2nd semester.
- Add a clause in their offer letter requiring good standing for TA positions to be assigned